



CRT Monitors

Cathode ray tube monitors – those bulky heavy monitors which occupied considerable space on your desktops – are on their way out, slowly but surely. According to a CyberMedia Research report, monitor manufacturers are pushing forth the LED backlit LCD monitors which has given a 59 percent increase in sales over just plain LCD monitors. Visit any local



Entry level graphics cards

website for buying monitors, and rarely will you come across any listing for CRT monitors. LCD monitors, which succeeded CRT monitors, are on a decline, so surely CRT monitors are in a much worse state. Mind you, India being a country where we literally tend to squeeze the juice out of our gadgets and continue to use them for

eternity, you will still find CRT monitors in use in most small offices. Although in places where real estate comes at a premium, LCD monitors are more practical than CRT monitors. Moreover, the prices of LCD and even LED backlit LCD monitors have come down to such an extent that buyers these days do not think twice before going for such monitors over their analogue counterparts. So CRT monitors which were the de facto standard for monitors just 5 years back, are on the path to oblivion sooner rather than later.

Consumer Video Cameras

This category just like the entry level graphics card, has been made redundant thanks to HD video recording capability available on phones as well as every other point and shoot camera on the market. There are no numbers available for the Indian market as far as consumer video cameras go, but a study done by the NPD group in the US market found out that camcorder sales had dropped by a whopping 42.5 per cent in the 2011 holiday season. That is a massive number and

indicative of the decline as far as the entry level consumer camera category goes. Sure dedicated camcorders offer better optical zoom, better video processing features, etc. but smartphones these days are capable of HD recording. There is a very niche segment who will shoot only videos for longer durations. Most of the video recording an average user will do will involve recording special moments, which can easily be shot on smartphones. Another advantage smartphones have is the ability to quickly upload these videos from the phone itself.

Other device which is less bulky and can shoot videos apart from taking good photographs are digital still point and shoot cameras. Take even the most entry-level point and shoot camera, it will have a 720p recording facility at the very least.

With camera technologies in smartphone and point and shoot cameras getting better by the day, the era of handheld camcorders is on a definite decline.

CD/DVD drives

There was a time when CD writers were a rage as it allowed you to burn 650 MegaBytes of data onto one drive. Back then 650MB was a huge step-up from the measly 1.44MB you got on a floppy drive. Succeeding the CD drives we had the DVD drives which gave a capacity of 4.7GB as a single layer DVD and about 8GB as a dual-layer DVD. Cut to today, when you can get a branded compact 16GB pen drive, which can easily fit in your jeans' pocket, for a mere Rs. 500. So for transferring data CD and DVD drives are for all practical purposes, dead. Probably the only time you will use your DVD drive is when you want to access the exclusive content on our DVD drives. You may ask, why Digit supplies DVDs in that case. Well our response to that is (a) the cost factor, DVDs are still cheaper than pen drives when it comes to large volumes and (b) we have heavy software in the DVD, which is easier to send across to readers, some of whom may not have high speed internet connection. The only optical media that is seeing a growth globally right now is Blu-ray drives. 

ARE THESE COMPANIES DYING AS WELL?

Five years ago these two companies were giants in their own right, but off late, they just seem to have become a shadow of their former glorious selves.

Research In Motion: When they came out with the BlackBerry and the proprietary email service, they had the mobile world in their palms, literally so for their users. But starting the end of last year, RIM is on a declining curve. The last major OS launched by BlackBerry was OS 7, sometime last year at this time and the next upgrade called BB 10 OS will be seen on devices at the end of this year. That is huge gap between OS upgrades, specially when Android and Apple come out with OS updates quite regularly. Another Achilles heel is that current BB users will not be able to upgrade to the newest OS. According to IDC, the global share of BlackBerry phones has dipped from 19 per cent in Q3 2009 to 15.3 per cent in Q3 2010 to a single-digit 6.7 per cent in Q1 2012. Need we say more?

Yahoo!: The former web star has been in the news off late for all the wrong reasons. We cannot exactly pinpoint to what event led to the decline, but two years back there was a huge uproar over Yahoo! laying off over 500 employees. Yahoo! had bought social bookmarking site Delicious and the photo sharing site Flickr even before Facebook became mainstream, but failed to see where the social web was headed. Flickr was an ace photo-sharing service, but right now Facebook is where people share photos on the web and in the mobile space Instagram (also a Facebook property) is the clear winner. In the search space Google dominates followed by Bing. In terms of ad sales, Yahoo is seeing a constant decline – just a minor 13.5 per cent compared to a 66.5 per cent share of Google (comScore April 2012 figures). Things are looking quite dire for this yesteryear search giant.